

RESEARCH BRIEF

Sales Onboarding Best Practices

What top teams do to ramp reps fast — and how we apply it.

Tu evento, tu marca, hecho bien.

Promo & Grow · Updated June 2026

For: Carlos · **Built:** June 6, 2026 · from current sales-enablement research (sources at the end). **Why this doc:** grounds the enablement materials we're building for Venus (and the future team) in what's proven to work.

The 6 findings that shaped our build

- 1. Structure the ramp in three phases — Learn → Apply → Accelerate.** The 30/60/90 model is the standard: Days 1–30 = product/process/tools + shadowing at ~25% productivity and **zero quota pressure**; Days 31–60 = supervised selling and pipeline building; Days 61–90 = independent selling. The payoff is real: structured onboarding **retains ~50% more new hires, cuts ramp time ~34%, and produces ~23% more first-year revenue**; highly structured programs cut ramp from ~9.1 to ~5.7 months. → We built Venus a 30/60/90 with this shape.
- 2. Gate on competency, not just activity.** The best programs use **milestone "certifications"** — the rep proves a skill before advancing, instead of just hitting call counts. → We added a Closer Certification with pass/fail gates per phase, tied to your rate ladder.
- 3. The core enablement kit is consistent everywhere:** playbook, scripts, battlecards, buyer personas, email templates, **role-play**, and **quizzes/certifications**. Battlecards + role-play "accelerate ramp time and keep messaging consistent" and make a natural foundation for certifications and quarterly refreshers. → You already have the playbook/scripts/price sheet; we're adding role-play, drills, and quizzes.
- 4. Objection handling has a backbone: LAER.** Listen → Acknowledge → Explore → Respond is the most-recommended mental model because it stops reps from answering an objection they haven't fully heard. Pair it with Feel-Felt-Found for price pushback. The stat that matters: **60% of sales need 5+ "no"s, but 44% of reps quit after the first** — persistence is a trainable edge. → Our objection drills are built on LAER + Feel-Felt-Found.
- 5. Make learning stick with microlearning + spaced repetition + retrieval practice.** 8–12 minute single-objective chunks, with **quizzes/flashcards at the end and repeated at spaced intervals**, move knowledge into long-term memory and beat one-time training. → The knowledge quiz and objection flashcards are designed as retrieval practice, meant to be repeated weekly.
- 6. For a remote rep, recorded calls are the unlock.** Live shadowing doesn't scale; top teams give new hires a **library of recorded top calls** to study (listen → take notes → debrief), then have the manager listen to the rep's live calls and give feedback, and finally "reverse-shadow" to confirm readiness. AI/role-play practice can cut ramp ~50%. → Venus is remote in El Salvador, so we lean on your Looms + a "study these calls" habit + role-play, not in-person shadowing.

How this maps to what we're giving Venus

Best practice	PNG deliverable
30/60/90 with competency gates	Ramp + Closer Certification
Playbook / scripts / price sheet	Closer Workbook + Master Price Sheet (already built)
Role-play + objection drills (LAER)	Role-Play Scenarios & Objection Drills
Quizzes as spaced retrieval	Interactive Knowledge Quiz (repeat weekly)
Quick-reference battlecard	Closer Cheat Sheet (one-pager)
Recorded top calls for remote ramp	Your Loom SOPs + "study + save standout calls" (Your Playbook)
Consistent, accurate source of truth	NotebookLM Source Packs (for your podcasts/videos)

Design principles we followed

- **Win early, win warm** — point her at proven warm buyers first (reactivation + drafts), no cold, no quota in month one.
- **Short and repeatable** — bite-size, quiz-reinforced, designed to revisit, not one-and-done.
- **Manage to the scoreboard** — competency gates + the weekly scorecard, not hovering.
- **Reusable for the team** — everything is templated so the next hire starts from the same system.

Sources

- [Hyperbound — 30/60/90 Day Ramp Plan](#)
- [Apollo — What Is a 30-60-90 Sales Plan](#)
- [Aircover — Sales Onboarding: Bring New Reps Up to Speed Fast](#)
- [Dock — 25 Sales Enablement Content Examples](#)
- [Docebo — Types of Sales Enablement Content](#)
- [Pitchbase — Objection Handling: 5 Frameworks + Scripts](#)
- [Orum — Mastering Objection Handling](#)
- [LearnDash — Spaced Repetition & Microlearning Boost Retention](#)
- [MaxLearn — Spaced Repetition & Retrieval Practice in Sales Training](#)
- [Alpharun — Sales Rep Onboarding Checklist](#)
- [Gong — Sales Onboarding \(recorded-call libraries\)](#)